

Terrified Virginians killed anyone believed associated with the revolt and finally captured Turner two months later and executed him. The revolt underscored the lie of contented slaves who harbored no ambitions for freedom or vengeance. After the revolt, the Virginia legislature debated the future of slavery in the state. Some recognized the evils of slavery; others feared that it slowed economic development and discouraged immigration. Yet others defended slavery as a financial necessity and as a part of God's plan to Christianize and civilize Africans. The possibility of gradual emancipation was discussed, but in the end, by a close vote, it was decided to end public discussion of the issue and to regulate the enslaved community more tightly.



Am I not a Man and a Brother?

London abolitionists campaigning for the end of slavery in the British Empire produced this medallion, designed by the firm of Josiah Wedgwood, in the 1790s. U.S. abolitionists adopted its motif of an enslaved man kneeling.

William Lloyd Garrison